"The UK benefits enormously from its diversity. When you have a Prime Minister called Rishi Sunak and his wife is called Akshata Murty. Those of you who went to my country 30-40 years ago, could you believe this would happen? No. Diversity expresses itself in different ways, including in politics and we are the stronger for it"

ALEX ELLIS *British High Commissioner to India*

"THE BUMP IN TIES (OVER THE ALLEGED CONSPIRACY TO KILL PANNUN) IS SERIOUS AND, LIKE ALL GOOD FRIENDS, WE DEALT WITH IT IN A SERIOUS WAY. BUT THE PACE OF OUR RELATIONSHIP HAS CONTINUED TO ACCELERATE EVEN IN THE MIDST OF IT"

ERIC GARCETTI
Ambassador of the United States to India



BRIDGING THE TWO OCEANS

The blue waters of the Indo-Pacific are on a slow simmer, heated by aggressive Chinese intent on the one hand and a matching strategic convergence of major powers through groupings such as the Quad (US, India, Japan, Australia) and AUKUS (Australia-UK-US). What precise role will India play on this new global maritime frontier? It goes beyond conflictual thinking. India, for one, is chary of calling the Quad only a military structure, a fact attested to by US ambassador to India Eric Garcetti, who also pointed to its economic, cultural and educational facets. "The Quad reflects the values and geography and our shared interest in a peaceful, democratic and accountable Indo-Pacific." All the Quad members share the same ideology and "our hearts feel alike", he said. Australian High Commissioner to India Philip Green said that India navigated the world with strategic autonomy. "So, it's up to India to decide where it fits into these partnerships for us." He also reiterated that the Quad tries to deal with a region that is "increasingly contested, where democracy is under threat and countries are increasingly unable to pursue their sovereignty in the ways that they want". The AUKUS, he said, "helps develop a world that can better avoid conflict and deter military action". The suggestions, of course, were towards the China threat.